R FOR DATA ANALYSIS · GETTING READY · LESSON 2

02 Install and load packages

Add extra tools to R with install.packages(), then switch them on with library().

BY THE END OF THIS SECTION YOU WILL BE ABLE TO

- Install a package once with install.packages()
- Load a package in each session with library()
- Read loading messages without worry

The R code in this lesson

```
# Install once
install.packages("tidyverse")
install.packages("readxl")
install.packages("dplyr")

# Load every time you start R
library("tidyverse")
library("readxl")
library("dplyr")

# Where is R looking for files?
getwd()
```

What you will hear (times count from the end of the intro)

Intro R comes with many tools, but the best ones live in packages that we add ourselves. In this lesson, you will learn to install packages, load them each time you work, and read the messages R shows you along the way. Let's set up our toolbox.

0:00 Here is our list. First, a note: installing a package. Under it, install dot packages, with the package name in quotes: tidyverse, Hmisc, corrplot, readxl, openxlsx, stargazer, dplyr, expss, and formattable.

0:22 You only need to install a package once on your computer. It is like installing an app on your phone.

0:32 But each time you open R, you need to load the packages you want to use. For that, we use library, with the package name inside.

0:45 I run the library lines one by one. The console fills with red text. Please don't panic. Most of it is just information, like: the following objects are masked.

1:00 Masked means two packages have a function with the same name, so R tells you which one it will use. It is not an error.

1:15 One message did say error: there is no package called colorspace. That means one package needs another one. Installing the missing package fixes it.

1:40 So remember: red text is not always an error. Read it calmly, and look for the word Error.

2:08 Now, a new question: where does R look for our files? The function getwd, get working directory, tells us. Run it, and R shows the folder path.

2:23 Here I open the folder on the computer, to see the session folders where our files are saved.

2:42 Next, setwd, set working directory, tells R which folder to use. We will do that carefully in the next lesson. Great progress!